

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

AI Integration into Architectural Practice

A 1-Year Plan · July 2026 – June 2027

PREPARED FOR

Firm Leadership / Principals

TOOLS COVERED

Finch (generative SD) · Claude Design (presentations) · SketchPro (DD/CD automation) · Custom Gemini Gems + Plaud.ai (meeting minutes) · Part3 (construction administration)

A note on accuracy: Tool descriptions in this plan are based on publicly available vendor materials as of this writing. Wherever pricing or a feature could not be confirmed from an official source, it is marked VERIFY rather than estimated. Confirm current figures directly with each vendor before budgeting or signing a contract.

OVERVIEW

Plan Philosophy

This plan phases AI tool adoption to follow the natural project lifecycle — schematic design, documentation, client communication, construction administration — so each tool is learned in the workflow context where it delivers the most value. Each quarter pairs a learning objective with a measurable, trackable output, building toward full AI-augmented practice by year-end.

Every tool section below includes a status tracker. Check the box that reflects current adoption stage at each leadership check-in, and use the notes line to record blockers or decisions needed from leadership.

MONTH 1

Establish Current Task Metrics

Before adopting any tool, capture an honest baseline so every later efficiency claim has a denominator to compare against.

What to log for 4 weeks

- Hours spent per task category: schematic massing/iteration, DD/CD drafting, meeting-minutes prep, presentation formatting, CA correspondence/submittal review.
- Revision-cycle counts — how many passes a typical SD package or set of minutes takes before approval.
- Error/omission rate on CDs — RFIs attributable to drafting inconsistency or coordination gaps.

Baseline data-collection progress

Not started	Learning	Piloting	Adopted	Optimized
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

Task Efficiency Tracker (fill in at each check-in)

Task category	Baseline (hrs/wk)	Current (hrs/wk)	Change
Schematic massing / iteration	_____	_____	_____
DD / CD drafting	_____	_____	_____
Meeting-minutes preparation	_____	_____	_____
Presentation / deliverable formatting	_____	_____	_____
CA correspondence / submittal review	_____	_____	_____

MONTHS 1–3 · SCHEMATIC DESIGN

Generative Massing — Finch

Build fluency in generative/parametric massing to accelerate SD options without losing design control.

Finch (Finch3D) [Live product]

What it does	Generates and optimizes floor plans from a building massing using graph-based AI; pushes results into Revit as native BIM geometry.
Vendor	Finch3D, Malmö, Sweden — finch3d.com
Revit support	Confirmed Revit 2022–2025 via Autodesk App Store plugin; also available for Rhino and ArchiCAD.
Pricing	VERIFY — Roughly \$250/month from third-party sources, with custom enterprise tiers
Best for	Early feasibility and unit-mix studies on multifamily, mixed-use, and commercial projects developed further in Revit.

Pilot activities:

- Complete Finch onboarding; reproduce one past SD study to benchmark against known results.
- Run one live project's massing study in parallel with manual iteration, timing both.
- Document a repeatable internal workflow and output-review checklist for studio-wide use.

Finch (Finch3D) — adoption status

Not started	Learning	Piloting	Adopted	Optimized
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

Milestone

Cut SD massing-option turnaround time vs. baseline, and publish an internal “Finch Quick-Start Guide.”

Milestone completion

0%	25%	50%	75%	Done
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

MONTHS 4–6 · CLIENT COMMUNICATION

Presentations — Claude Design

Streamline client-facing presentations and design narratives while keeping firm branding consistent.

Claude Design [Research preview]

What it does	Generates polished decks, one-pagers, and prototypes from a conversation; can apply a saved firm design system automatically.
Vendor	Anthropic Labs — claude.ai/design
Availability	Confirmed for Claude Pro, Max, Team, and Enterprise plans; status is “research preview,” so behavior may change.
Pricing / credits	<i>VERIFY — Anthropic has not published exact credit counts or slide limits per tier — check current Claude plan pricing before relying on it for a deliverable timeline</i>
Export	Decks render as interactive HTML in-canvas; confirm current PPTX export / hand-off options in-app, as these can change.

Pilot activities:

- Build a reusable presentation template (boards, narrative structure, image placeholders) matching firm branding.
- Pilot on two client deliverables: one SD presentation, one design-narrative document.
- Get a principal/senior associate to review visual and narrative quality against prior manually built decks.

Claude Design — adoption status

Not started	Learning	Piloting	Adopted	Optimized
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

Milestone

Reduce presentation-production time per deliverable vs. baseline; establish an “AI-assisted vs. human-refined” QA checklist.

Milestone completion

0%	25%	50%	75%	Done
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

MONTHS 7–9 · DESIGN DEVELOPMENT / CONSTRUCTION DOCUMENTS

Documentation Automation — SketchPro

Integrate AI-assisted drafting into DD/CD production to improve consistency and reduce repetitive drafting work — without removing licensed review.

SketchPro [Live product]

What it does	Runs inside live Revit models; executes dimensioning, tagging, view setup, and schedules from natural-language instructions, configured to firm standards.
Vendor	SketchPro — sketchpro.ai, founded 2023
Note	The vendor also offers a separate AI rendering/visualization product under the same brand — confirm which SketchPro product (documentation copilot vs. rendering tool) you are evaluating.
Pricing	VERIFY — Not publicly listed — request current pricing directly from SketchPro
Best for	Firms with established Revit drawing standards who want to cut repetitive dimensioning/tagging time.

Pilot activities:

- Configure SketchPro with firm-specific CD standards (sheet templates, annotation conventions, detail callouts).
- Pilot on one DD package and one CD package, with a licensed architect reviewing all AI-generated output before issuance.
- Compare resulting drawings against baseline revision-cycle and error/omission metrics.

SketchPro — adoption status

Not started	Learning	Piloting	Adopted	Optimized
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

Milestone

Reduce DD/CD revision cycles and coordination-related RFIs vs. baseline; document a mandatory human-review QA protocol for anything touching code/life-safety items.

Milestone completion

0%	25%	50%	75%	Done
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

MONTHS 10–12 · MEETING DOCUMENTATION & CONSTRUCTION ADMINISTRATION

Meetings & CA — Gemini Gems + Part3

Automate meeting documentation and speed up Construction Administration response cycles.

Custom Gemini Gem (fed by Plaud.ai transcripts) [Live product]

What it does	A Gemini Gem is a custom-instructed version of Gemini configured once with a prompt/template; feed it a Plaud.ai transcript and it restructures the recording into firm-standard meeting minutes (attendees, decisions, action items, open issues).
Vendor	Google Gemini (custom Gem feature), paired with Plaud.ai recorder/transcription
Availability	<i>VERIFY — Custom Gem access and Plaud.ai transcript-export options depend on current Gemini and Plaud.ai subscription tiers — confirm both before building the workflow</i>
Data handling	<i>VERIFY — Confirm each vendor's current data-retention and confidentiality terms before processing client meeting recordings</i>
Best for	Converting raw recordings into a consistent, distributable minutes format with minimal manual cleanup.

Pilot activities:

- Build and refine a Gem prompt/template matching the firm's standard minutes format.
- Run it on 6–8 live project meetings; track manual edit time vs. fully manual minute-taking.
- Finalize a firm-wide SOP: Plaud.ai recording → Gemini Gem draft → human review → distribution.

Gemini Gem workflow — adoption status

Not started	Learning	Piloting	Adopted	Optimized
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

Part3 [Live product]

What it does	AI-powered Submittal Assistant compares submittals to specs, flags mismatches, and summarizes long packages; ProjectFiles auto-detects drawing revisions and keeps teams on the latest set.
Vendor	Part3, Toronto, Canada — part3.io
Pricing	Vendor's site states annual subscriptions start at \$9,000/year — confirm the current figure and what it includes before budgeting, as published pricing can change.
Integrations	Vendor materials describe compatibility alongside Procore, Deltek, and Bluebeam workflows.
Best for	Firms managing high submittal/RFI volume who want AI-assisted review rather than manual spec cross-checking.

Pilot activities:

- Onboard Part3 on one active CA project; configure submittal logs and project specs.
- Pilot the Submittal Assistant and ProjectFiles revision tracking against current manual process.
- Track CA administrative time (submittal/RFI processing) against baseline.

Part3 — adoption status

Not started	Learning	Piloting	Adopted	Optimized
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

Q4 Milestone

Reduce meeting-minutes turnaround time and CA administrative time vs. baseline; finalize the combined Plaud.ai → Gemini Gem → distribution SOP.

Milestone completion

0%	25%	50%	75%	Done
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Notes / blockers: _____

YEAR-ROUND TRACKING

Year-End Goals

- **Efficiency** — demonstrate measurable time savings in each of the five workflow areas above, validated against the Month-1 baseline.
- **Consistency & repeatability** — convert each pilot workflow into a documented SOP usable by other team members, not just the pilot user.
- **Quality control** — confirm AI-assisted output (especially CDs and CA documents) has maintained or improved accuracy, with mandatory human review on anything touching code compliance or contractual CA decisions.

Consistency goal in practice: once a workflow's time change is consistently negative (less time, same or better output) across more than one team member, convert it into a documented SOP so the gain holds when someone else on the team runs the workflow.